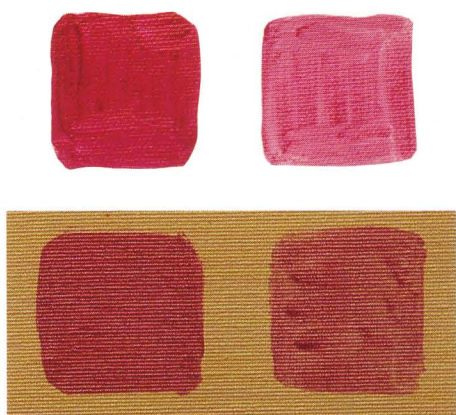


PAINTING ON A WHITE GROUND



Influencing the look of a color

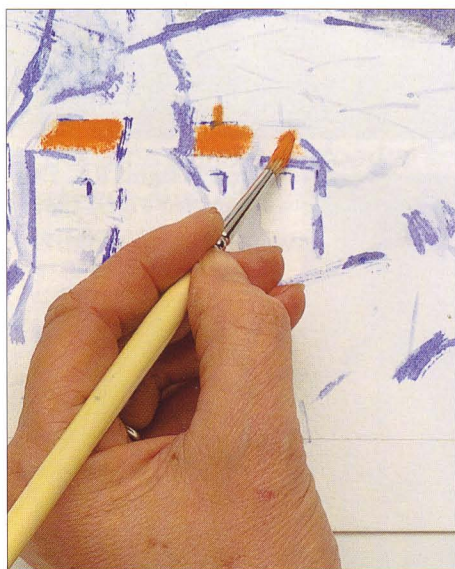
These examples of Permanent Rose demonstrate how easily the appearance of a color changes. The top squares, painted first thickly and then thinly, retain their brilliance and purity on a white surface. A colored ground (above) subdues the luminosity of the transparent paint.

A WHITE GROUND PROVIDES a perfect surface for reflecting the purity of a color painted over it. A transparent color that looks dark in a tube appears as a brilliant saturated hue when it is painted thinly over a white surface. Semi-opaque and even opaque colors are also given a particular clarity on a white ground, especially since there is often a variation in thickness between individual brushstrokes. Generally, more painting is required on a white ground in order to cover the white surface, while a colored or toned ground provides a useful unifying matrix between the brushstrokes of different color.



Make a sketch on white paper to plan the color scheme

SINCE WHITE REPRESENTS the brightest highlight a painter can create, most of the white ground in this exercise has been covered to achieve a more accurate representation of tones. As you paint over the white ground, bear in mind that the colors you paint will initially look much darker on the dazzling white surface than they will when you have finished the painting and covered up most of the white ground.



1 A white ground suits this subject matter perfectly, as it can illuminate the colors painted over it to give a sensation of strong summer light. Sketch the landscape with thinned paint and a small round bristle brush, and then block in main areas of color with a clean brush.



2 This work relies on strong color to make its impact, so use pure complementary colors to achieve the maximum effect. Pick out areas of the foreground with warm colors such as orange, yellow, and red, and then complement them with cooler colors such as blue, violet, and green in the distance. Cover as much of the white surface as possible with the thin mixes of color.



3 Use a cold, clean blue, such as Cerulean Blue, for the sky. To avoid painting a heavy, flat area of color, lighten some Ultramarine Blue with touches of white and use it to break up the large expanse of sky with a long filbert bristle brush. Keep this paint dry and thick so that you can create a scumbled effect over the first layer of paint. This should give the sky a richer texture and a deeper tone.